UseThisSI

The UseThisSI Builder Stack

The 25 AI tools we'd actually use to build, ship and grow, sorted by the job and checked for price.

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usethissi.vercel.app

Why this stack Read this first

There's a new "AI tool of the day" every hour. Most of them don't matter. This guide is the short list: the tools we'd reach for if we had to build something real this week.

- **Top picks first.** Our #1 choice for each of 10 jobs, from vibe-coding an app to voice and research.
- **Then the bench.** 15 strong alternatives for when the top pick doesn't fit your budget or workflow.
- **Honest prices.** Prices are taken from our directory. Where we couldn't verify a price, we say "check vendor site" rather than guess. Prices change, so confirm before you buy.
- **A setup tip for each tool** to get you to a useful result in your first session.

Every tool links to its full page on UseThisSI with alternatives and updates. Get the free weekday brief at **usethissi.beehiiv.com**.

The 25 at a glance

01	Lovable	Vibe-code an app or landing page	$25/mo Pro
02	Cursor	AI coding assistant	$8/mo Plus (Grok models only); $30/mo Premium
03	n8n	Set up or run AI agents	€20/mo Starter, billed annually
04	Make	Automate workflows	$9/mo Core (annual)
05	Scenario	Make game art and sprites	$15/mo Starter
06	Suno	Generate music and SFX	$10/mo Pro; Premier $24/mo billed annually
07	Runway	Edit and generate video	$12/mo billed annually, $15 monthly
08	Claude	Write content	$17/mo annual, $20 monthly
09	Perplexity	Research	$20/mo Pro
10	ElevenLabs	Voice and TTS	$6/mo Starter ($1 first month until Oct 18)
11	Bolt.new	Vibe-code an app or landing page	$25/mo Pro
12	v0 by Vercel	Vibe-code an app or landing page	$30/user/mo
13	Claude Code	AI coding assistant	$17/mo annual, $20 monthly
14	GitHub Copilot	AI coding assistant	$10/mo Pro
15	Zapier	Automate workflows	$19.99/mo
16	CrewAI	Set up or run AI agents	$99/mo
17	Midjourney	Make game art and sprites	$10/mo Basic
18	Ideogram	Make game art and sprites	$15/mo Plus
19	ElevenLabs Music and SFX	Generate music and SFX	$6/mo
20	Descript	Edit and generate video	$16/mo annual, $24 monthly
21	HeyGen	Edit and generate video	$29/mo Creator
22	ChatGPT	Write content	$8/mo Go, $20 Plus
23	Gamma	Write content	$12/mo Plus
24	NotebookLM	Research	$4.99/mo via Google AI Plus
25	Cartesia	Voice and TTS	$5/mo Pro

The Top Picks Our #1 tool for each job

01 Lovable TOP PICK

Vibe-code an app or landing page

Best for: Chat-to-full-stack app with hosting; easiest on-ramp

PRICE	FREE TIER
$25/mo Pro	Yes (5 build credits/day)

Setup tip: Write a one-paragraph spec (pages, users, data) before your first prompt, and connect GitHub early so you own the code.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/lovable/

02 Cursor TOP PICK

AI coding assistant

Best for: Leading AI IDE with cloud agents

PRICE	FREE TIER
$8/mo Plus (Grok models only); $30/mo Premium	Yes (limited)

Setup tip: Add a project rules file describing your stack and conventions; it keeps every agent edit on-style.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/cursor/

03 n8n TOP PICK

Set up or run AI agents

Best for: Open-source agent and workflow builder

PRICE	FREE TIER
€20/mo Starter, billed annually	Yes (self-host); Cloud 14-day trial

Setup tip: Start from a community template, then swap in your credentials. Self-host with Docker if you want unlimited runs.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/n8n/

The Top Picks Our #1 tool for each job

04 Make TOP PICK

Automate workflows

Best for: Visual automation with the best affiliate terms

PRICE	FREE TIER
$9/mo Core (annual)	Yes

Setup tip: Build the scenario with 'Run once' and sample data first, then turn on scheduling. Watch your operations count.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/make/

05 Scenario TOP PICK

Make game art and sprites

Best for: Style-trained, consistent game assets

PRICE	FREE TIER
$15/mo Starter	Yes (50 credits/day)

Setup tip: Train a custom model on 10-20 of your own reference images so every asset stays in one consistent style.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/scenario/

06 Suno TOP PICK

Generate music and SFX

Best for: Best song gen with commercial rights on Pro

PRICE	FREE TIER
$10/mo Pro; Premier $24/mo billed annually	Yes (50 credits/day, no commercial use)

Setup tip: Put genre, tempo and mood in the style box and keep lyrics separate. Free tier is non-commercial, so upgrade before you ship.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/suno/

The Top Picks Our #1 tool for each job

07 Runway TOP PICK

Edit and generate video

Best for: Pro-grade generative video

PRICE	FREE TIER
$12/mo billed annually, $15 monthly	Yes (125 one-time credits)

Setup tip: Lock a strong still image first, then animate it; image-to-video gives far more control than text alone.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/runway/

08 Claude TOP PICK

Write content

Best for: Best long-form writing voice

PRICE	FREE TIER
$17/mo annual, $20 monthly	Yes

Setup tip: Create a Project with your style guide and examples attached so every draft starts with your context.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/claude/

09 Perplexity TOP PICK

Research

Best for: Fast cited answers

PRICE	FREE TIER
$20/mo Pro	Yes

Setup tip: Use Spaces to save sources and instructions per topic, and always click through to verify key citations.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/perplexity/

The Top Picks Our #1 tool for each job

10 ElevenLabs TOP PICK

Voice and TTS

Best for: Most realistic voices plus 22% recurring affiliate

PRICE	FREE TIER
$6/mo Starter ($1 first month until Oct 18)	Yes (10k credits)

Setup tip: Clone your voice from a clean 1-2 minute recording in a quiet room; audio quality matters more than length.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/elevenlabs/

The Bench Strong alternatives worth knowing

11 Bolt.new

Vibe-code an app or landing page

Best for: Fast browser app builder, hosting included

PRICE	FREE TIER
$25/mo Pro	Yes (1M tokens/mo)

Setup tip: Ask for the scaffold first, then iterate one feature per prompt to save tokens and avoid regressions.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/bolt-new/

12 v0 by Vercel

Vibe-code an app or landing page

Best for: Best React UI, deploys to Vercel

PRICE	FREE TIER
$30/user/mo	Yes ($5 credits)

Setup tip: Paste a screenshot of a UI you like as a reference, then deploy straight to Vercel when it looks right.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/v0-by-vercel/

13 Claude Code

AI coding assistant

Best for: Terminal coding agent

PRICE	FREE TIER
$17/mo annual, $20 monthly	No (needs paid Claude)

Setup tip: Run /init in your repo to generate a CLAUDE.md, then keep it updated with build and test commands.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/claude-code/

The Bench Strong alternatives worth knowing

14 GitHub Copilot

AI coding assistant

Best for: Works in your existing editor

PRICE	FREE TIER
$10/mo Pro	Yes

Setup tip: Turn on Copilot in your editor and use chat with #file references so answers use the right context.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/github-copilot/

15 Zapier

Automate workflows

Best for: Largest integration catalog

PRICE	FREE TIER
$19.99/mo	Yes

Setup tip: Begin with a two-step Zap, test each step with real data, then add filters to avoid wasting tasks.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/zapier/

16 CrewAI

Set up or run AI agents

Best for: Multi-agent framework plus cloud

PRICE	FREE TIER
$99/mo	Yes (50 executions/mo)

Setup tip: Define each agent's role, goal and tools narrowly; small focused crews beat one do-everything agent.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/crewai/

The Bench Strong alternatives worth knowing

17 Midjourney

Make game art and sprites

Best for: Top-tier concept art

PRICE	FREE TIER
$10/mo Basic	No

Setup tip: Use --sref with an image you like to keep a consistent style across a whole asset set.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/midjourney/

18 Ideogram

Make game art and sprites

Best for: Best text-in-image (logos, UI)

PRICE	FREE TIER
$15/mo Plus	Yes

Setup tip: Reach for it when you need readable text inside images: logos, posters and thumbnails.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/ideogram/

19 ElevenLabs Music and SFX

Generate music and SFX

Best for: SFX and music on the TTS plan

PRICE	FREE TIER
$6/mo	Yes

Setup tip: Describe sounds concretely (material, distance, length), e.g. 'short wooden door creak, close mic'.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/elevenlabs-music-and-sfx/

The Bench Strong alternatives worth knowing

20 Descript

Edit and generate video

Best for: Edit video by editing text

PRICE	FREE TIER
$16/mo annual, $24 monthly	Yes

Setup tip: Edit video by editing the transcript, then run Studio Sound to clean up audio in one click.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/descript/

21 HeyGen

Edit and generate video

Best for: AI avatar presenter videos with voice clone and translation

PRICE	FREE TIER
$29/mo Creator	Yes (3 videos/mo)

Setup tip: Record a 2-minute avatar video with steady lighting and eye contact for the most natural results.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/heygen/

22 ChatGPT

Write content

Best for: All-rounder; GPT-6 on all tiers

PRICE	FREE TIER
$8/mo Go, $20 Plus	Yes

Setup tip: Set Custom Instructions with who you are and how you like answers, so you stop repeating context.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/chatgpt/

The Bench Strong alternatives worth knowing

23 Gamma

Write content

Best for: AI decks, docs and sites

PRICE	FREE TIER
$12/mo Plus	Yes

Setup tip: Paste an outline or doc and let Gamma build the deck, then apply your brand theme once.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/gamma/

24 NotebookLM

Research

Best for: Grounded in your own sources

PRICE	FREE TIER
$4.99/mo via Google AI Plus	Yes

Setup tip: Upload your own PDFs and docs as sources; answers stay grounded and cite where they came from.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/notebooklm/

25 Cartesia

Voice and TTS

Best for: Low-latency voice for agents

PRICE	FREE TIER
$5/mo Pro	Yes (20K credits)

Setup tip: Test the low-latency API in the playground first if you are building a real-time voice agent.

usethissi.vercel.app/tools/cartesia/

Build something this week.

Know a tool that belongs here? Reply to any UseThisSI brief and tell us. Thanks for sharing UseThisSI. At 10 referrals you get a shout-out in the brief.

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